REFLECTION

وَعَاشِرُوهُنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ

What the Qur'an Says About Women

An-Nisa 4:19

sajidkhan.substack.com

REFLECTION

What the Qur'an Says About Women

Surah An-Nisa 4:19

Before Islam, a widow in Arabia could be "inherited" by her husband's family like property, or kept from remarrying so that her dowry could be taken back. The Qur'an put an end to it in Surah An-Nisa (4:19):

In the Qur'an:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا يَحِلُّ لَكُمْ أَن تَرِثُوا النِّسَاءَ كَرْهًا ۖ وَلَا تَعْضُلُوهُنَّ لِتَذْهَبُوا بِبَعْضِ مَا آتَيْتُمُوهُنَّ إِلَّا أَن يَأْتِينَ بِفَاحِشَةٍ مُّبَيِّنَةٍ ۚ وَعَاشِرُوهُنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ ۚ فَإِن كَرِهْتُمُوهُنَّ فَعَسَىٰ أَن تَكْرَهُوا شَيْئًا وَيَجْعَلَ اللَّهُ فِيهِ خَيْرًا كَثِيرًا ﴿١٩﴾

"Believers, it is not lawful for you to inherit women against their will, nor to treat them harshly to take back part of what you gave them, unless they are guilty of open indecency. Live with them in kindness. If you dislike them, it may be that you dislike something in which Allah has placed much good."

Three commands

- **No forcing:** كَرْهًا "against their will". A woman is not property.
- **No pressuring:** وَلَا تَعْضُلُوهُنَّ "do not hold them back or make life hard for them" to get money from them.
- **Live with them in kindness:** وَعَاشِرُوهُنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ. The word مَعْرُوف means what is known to be good and fair.

And even when a husband dislikes something in his wife, he is told to be patient: Allah may have put much good in it.

Get the free lessons: a new grammar post or reflection every Tuesday and Thursday at sajidkhan.substack.com. More lessons at ibnqutb.com; books and apps at seemabooks.com.